Learn the Signs. Act Early.

Milestones by 2 Years

TABLE OF CONTENTS | PAGE 8 OF 13 | ALL PAGES ↓

For Everyone

MAY 15, 2026 • ESPAÑOL

WHAT TO KNOW

- Learn about the developmental milestones that most children do by 2 years of age.
- See important information to share with your doctor.
- Find tips and activities you can do for your 2-year-old.



Ways to monitor milestones

How your child plays, learns, speaks, acts, and moves offers important clues about your child's development. Developmental miles things most children (75% or more) can do by a certain age.

Milestone checklists

Check the milestones your child has reached by 2 years by completing a checklist, available below and in three additional formats:

- CDC's free Milestone Tracker mobile app, for iOS and Android devices
- Web-based Digital Online Checklist
- Printable checklist PDF

Keep in mind

Learn the Signs. Act Early. materials are not a substitute for standardized, validated developmental screening tools.

What most children do by 2 years

Click the links below to view a photo or video of each milestone.

Social/Emotional Milestones

- Notices when others are hurt or upset, like pausing or looking sad when someone is crying
- Looks at your face to see how to react in a new situation

Language/Communication Milestones

- Points to things in a book when you ask, like “Where is the bear?”
- Says at least two words together, like “More milk.”
- Points to at least two body parts when you ask him to show you
- Uses more gestures than just waving and pointing, like blowing a kiss or nodding yes

Cognitive Milestones (learning, thinking, problem-solving)

- Holds something in one hand while using the other hand; for example, holding a container and taking the lid off
- Tries to use switches, knobs, or buttons on a toy
- Plays with more than one toy at the same time, like putting toy food on a toy plate

Movement/Physical Development Milestones

- Kicks a ball
- Runs
- Walks (not climbs) up a few stairs with or without help
- Eats with a spoon

SEE ALSO
More about physical development

Share with your child’s doctor

Things to share and consider

- What are some things you and your child do together?
- What are some things your child likes to do?
- Is there anything your child does or does not do that concerns you?
- Has your child lost any skills he/she once had?
- Does your child have any special healthcare needs or was he/she born prematurely?

You know your child best. Don't wait. If your child is not meeting one or more milestones, has lost skills he or she once had, or you concerns, act early. Talk with your child's doctor, share your concerns, and ask about developmental screening.

If you or the doctor are still concerned

- Ask for a referral to a specialist who can evaluate your child more; and
- Call your state or territory's early intervention program to find out if your child can get services to help. Learn more and find t at cdc.gov/FindEI.

KEEP READING

Concerned About Your Child's Development?

Tips and activities

What You Can Do for Your 2-year-old



As your child's first teacher, you can help his or her development.

As your child's first teacher, you can help his or her learning and brain development. Try these simple tips and activities in a safe w your child's doctor and teachers if you have questions or for more ideas on how to help your child's development.

- Help your child learn how words sound, even if he can't say them clearly yet. For example, if your child says, "or nana," say "You banana."
- Watch your child closely during playdates. Children this age play next to each other, but do not know how to share and solve pr your child how to deal with conflicts by helping her share, take turns, and use words when possible.
- Have your child help you get ready for mealtime, by letting him carry things to the table, such as plastic cups or napkins. Thank y helping.

More Parenting Tips and Activities

- Give your child balls to kick, roll, and throw.
- Give toys that teach your child how to make things work and how to solve problems. For example, give her toys where she c button and something happens.
- Let your child play dress up with grown-up clothes, such as shoes, hats, and shirts. This helps him begin to pretend play.
- Allow your child to eat as much or as little as she wants at each meal. Toddlers don't always eat the same amount or type of day. Your job is to offer her healthy foods and it's your child's job to decide if and how much she needs to eat.
- Have steady routines for sleeping and feeding. Create a calm, quiet bedtime for your child. Put on his pajamas, brush his teet 1 or 2 books to him. Children this age need 11 to 14 hours of sleep a day (including naps). Consistent sleep times make it ea
- Ask your child's doctor and/or teachers about toilet training to know if your child is ready to start. Most children are not able train until 2 to 3 years old. Starting too early can cause stress and setbacks, which can cause training to take longer.
- Use positive words when your child is being a good helper. Let him help with simple chores, such as putting toys or laundry
- Play with your child outside, by playing "ready, set, go." For example, pull your child back in a swing. Say "Ready, set....", ther say "Go" when you push the swing.
- Let your child create simple art projects with you. Give your child crayons or put some finger paint on paper and let her explo spreading it around and making dots. Hang it on the wall or refrigerator so your child can see it.
- Use positive words and give more attention to behaviors you want to see ("wanted behaviors"), than to those you don't want example, say "Look how well you're eating with your spoon."
- Let your child play with sand toys or plastic containers, spoons, or a funnel in the tub or in a sandbox.
- Help your child do simple puzzles with shapes, colors, or animals. Name each piece when your child puts it in place.
- Encourage your child's curiosity and help her learn and explore new things. Take her to the park, take walks, or go on a bus r
- Sing songs, such as "Head, Shoulders, Knees, and Toes," to teach names of body parts. After singing it a few times, see if you sings some of the words when you touch a body part and wait.
- Limit screen time (TV, tablets, phones, etc.) to no more than 1 hour a day of a children's program with an adult present. Child by talking, playing, and interacting with others.
- Encourage your child to play with blocks. Take turns building towers and knocking them down.
- Ask your child to help you open the drawer when you put away clothes or open the door when you go outside.

TABLE OF CONTENTS | TABLE OF CONTENTS

- Milestones by 2 Months
- Milestones by 4 Months
- Milestones by 6 Months

SHOW MORE

SOURCES AND PAGE INFO

CONTENT SOURCE

National Center on Birth Defects and Developmental Disabilities (NCBDDD)

ABOUT THIS PAGE

Published: September 4, 2025

Updated: May 16, 2026

This page was last updated on this date. Updates may include minor edits, image changes, or other modifications to page content.

Reviewed: May 16, 2026

The information on this page was last reviewed by subject matter experts to ensure accuracy.

SOURCES

- *Special acknowledgments to the subject matter experts and others who contributed to the review of data and selection of deve milestones, especially Paul H. Lipkin, MD, Michelle M. Macias, MD, Julie F. Pajek, PhD, Judith S. Shaw, EdD, MPH, RN, Karnesha MPH, Jane K. Squires, PhD, Toni M. Whitaker, MD, Lisa D. Wiggins, PhD, and Jennifer M. Zubler, MD.*
- *Sincere gratitude to Natalia Benza, MD and José O. Rodríguez, MD, MBA for their thoughtful review of the Spanish-language tr these milestones.*